



Binance hacked

Binance was hacked for over \$40 million worth of Bitcoin in a massive security breach. <https://digit.in/june19-19>



Swipe to type on iOS

iOS may adopt the swipe to type feature soon which has been long present on Android. <https://digit.in/june19-20>

giving the users a range of choices. When you fire up Uber, it shows you a location that you might be headed to, based on where you are and your history with the app. These small features make apps incredibly easy to use, but are almost invisible to the end user. A more overt example is Spotify providing you daily playlists based on your listening habits. “Currently, UX personalisation is being focused in the market throughout India. It is all about creating a customized user experience that is relevant and targeted towards a particular user or a group of users’ needs.” Saxena says.

THE DESIGN LANGUAGE

The design languages used for the apps and the operating systems have evolved. The first few generations of the iPhone used what is called skeuomorphic design, which used familiar real world objects to allow users to get familiar with a brand new category of devices. The calculator looked like a real calculator and the ebook reader allowed you to flip pages like an actual book. Most modern operating systems, including iOS have opted for minimalism and flat UI design, which is less taxing on the resources of the phone. The user experience is streamlined and responsive. The memos app on the iPhone now shows a stylised waveform, instead of a microphone. Flat design is particularly popular in India, and apps such as BHIM, were lauded for their simple to understand interface and clean design.

Sudhir Mantena, Director of Products at Cleartrip explains, “User experience has been a big focus area right from the time we established shop. One of the cofounders, Hrush Bhat is a big name when it comes to the design world. Some of the early designers who were with Cleartrip also have the same bent of mind. So, right from day one, the ethos was always about the consumer journey and the user experience. We were one of the first companies to launch split screen in India. In a round trip scenario, our search results will show a split screen.

This is an extremely hard problem to solve on a mobile platform, given the limited real estate.”

Google has incorporated flat UI design in its material design language with slight animations to convey information to the user.

“UX designing has started to move on a more engaging level with responsive animations, 3D icons, light and shading features, transitions, etc. Since the introduction of material design. We have now shifted from bland minimalism, crispness and brightness of flat design to liveliness, increased interactivity, detailed adaptability of design to various devices, customization, and a user-centric approach.” Saxena says.

While skeuomorphic design might now be considered outdated, it is making a comeback for XR applications and wearables, such as the faces for smartwatches. The situation becomes



The evolution of UI design

complicated in India as there are still many users who are buying their first smartphones. When designing UI for India, companies have to keep in mind that the end users may be smartphone novices or well-versed.

Saxena explains, “Our audience varies from people using smartphones for the first time to users with experiences of 5 years and more. This means whatever we design, needs to be simple enough for new smartphone adopters, yet at the same time appeal to a user who is more advanced and expects a better experience out of the app.”

NEW FEATURES

Cleartrip identified a need, and served it. Mantena explains, “A lot of our customers were also very frequent bookers. We also noticed that these users travel alone most of the time, and their destinations were more or less fixed. Their payment instru-

ments were also set. So why should a consumer have to go and put all of this information every single time that they make a booking? We built something called Expressway, which is one of the fastest ways for you to go book a ticket. You can start from inputting your origin destination and travel date, and in less than 60 seconds you can complete your payment and have an eticket in your hand. That is coming out of seeing what the customer is doing and understanding the customer’s behaviour, and having that empathy towards the customer. The experience becomes as superlative. There are so many such features which are industry first, not just in India but globally also, especially from a user experience and design point of view.”

The team at LIKE constantly keeps adding features that users want, based on their demands, “based out of Singapore, LIKE is a video editing and special effects tool – we focus more on providing video editing function options through advanced

technology research and development, to be able to bring better video creation experience and effects to users. In addition to Dynamic stickers, LIKE has more than 300+ unique special effects like 4D magic, Music Magic, Superme, Super Power to name a few.” This approach allows LIKE to ride on the popularity of trends, such as user made videos, “short videos are a global trend. Such apps offer an ease of use with multiple special effects and stickers to meet the needs of users for the creation of videos, thus fast gaining in popularity. For LIKE, we will continue to be optimized from the technical side to bring unique video creation experience to local users.”

Through the testing processes, and by tracking the journeys of thousands of users through the application, the developers get an idea of the pain points of the users and where they are achieving their goals successfully.